

THE STANDARD: FAT LOSS GUIDE.

Nutrition · Fat Loss · Meal Plan · Adjustments

Your numbers. Your food. Your framework.

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INCLUDES

- 3-Day Strength Training Program
- Cardio Protocol + NEAT
- Check-Ins + Adjustment System
- Complete Nutrition Framework
- 7-Day Meal Plan + Grocery List

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"Nothing changes if nothing changes." — Start here. Do the work. Trust the process.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

HOW THIS WORKS

The system, the order of operations, what to expect

01

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

01 — OVERVIEW

The order of operations.

This isn't a 30-day shred. It's the system I run with every fat loss client — the same structure across the board, scaled to where you are right now. The structure never changes. Your numbers do.

What I've noticed coaching women through this: fat loss doesn't stall because you're not trying hard enough. It stalls because the plan asks for perfection instead of consistency. This plan asks for consistency.

"Lift to keep your muscle, walk to drive the deficit, eat enough protein to make both count. Cardio is the last lever we pull — not the first."

The Three Things That Actually Move the Needle

→ Strength training 3 days a week. Muscle is your metabolic engine. After 30, you lose 3–8% of muscle mass per decade unless you actively work to build and maintain it.

→ Protein at every meal. 0.7–1g per pound of goal body weight. Most women are eating about half of that. This one shift changes everything downstream.

→ Recovery is the work. Sleep is where your muscles repair, where cortisol resets. Rest days are part of the program — not taking them is not a virtue.

What's Actually Happening After 35

Fluctuating estrogen disrupts insulin sensitivity. Lower progesterone affects sleep and stress response. Higher cortisol sensitivity means your body is quicker to store fat and slower to release it. Your metabolism is not broken. Your strategy is just outdated.

Under-eating suppresses your metabolism further. Adequate protein and strength training can meaningfully reverse the slowdown. The goal is to work with your body, not punish it.

You don't need to eat less. You need to eat smarter — and almost certainly more protein than you think.

The Weekly Shape

Day	Focus	Time
Day 1	Strength — Lower (squat focus)	45–55 min
Day 2	Strength — Upper (push focus)	45–55 min
Day 3	Strength — Full Body (hinge focus)	45–55 min
Day 4	LISS Cardio — zone 2	35–45 min
Day 5	Intervals	20 min

Daily	Steps: 8–10k (start at your average +2k)	—
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Strength days can run Mon/Wed/Fri or whatever fits your actual life. The non-negotiable is that they happen — not when.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

CARDIO PROTOCOL

Steps, LISS, intervals — a tool, not punishment

02

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

02 — CARDIO

Cardio is a tool.

Cardio doesn't earn food and it isn't punishment. It has two jobs: daily movement that quietly drives the deficit, and two structured sessions that keep your engine strong.

We never add cardio before adjusting food first. More cardio on top of too little food is how women end up exhausted, hungry, and stuck.

The Real Driver: Steps

Daily steps move the needle more than any single workout. Find your current 7-day average, add 2,000, and live there for two weeks before going up again. Target range: 8–10k daily.

Structured Session 1 — LISS

35–45 minutes at a pace where you can hold a conversation (zone 2). Incline walk, bike, rower — whichever one you'll actually do. Recovery-friendly. Doesn't spike hunger the way hard cardio does.

Structured Session 2 — Intervals

20 minutes total: 30 seconds hard, 90 seconds easy, repeated 8–10 times. 'Hard' means you couldn't keep it up for 2 minutes — not all-out collapse.

The cardio rule: we never add cardio before adjusting food first. Cardio is the LAST lever.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

NUTRITION FRAMEWORK

Your numbers, the plate method, the 80/20 rule

03

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

03 — NUTRITION

Same system. Different numbers.

No banned foods, no cleanses, no eating like you're apologizing for something. Same framework for everyone — different numbers for each body. The 80/20 rule applies: if 80% of your food does its job, the other 20% is yours.

Your Starting Numbers

What	Formula	Example (170 lb, goal 150)
Calories (starting point)	Bodyweight (lbs) × 12	170 × 12 = ~2,040/day
Protein (the one we track)	0.8–1g per lb of goal weight	120–150g/day
Adjustments	±100–150 cal every 2 weeks	Based on trend, not one weigh-in

Daily Protein Targets by Goal Weight

Goal Weight	Daily Protein Target
120–130 lbs	85–130g / day
131–145 lbs	92–145g / day
146–160 lbs	102–160g / day
161–175 lbs	113–175g / day
176–190 lbs	123–190g / day
191–200+ lbs	134–200g / day

Start at the lower end and build up over 2–3 weeks. Aim for 30–40g per meal across 3–4 meals.

The Plate Method

Food	Per Meal	Your Hand Is the Measure
Protein	Every meal	1 palm (2 at dinner)
Vegetables	At least 2 meals	1 fist minimum
Carbs	Scaled to training days	1 cupped hand (add 1 on lifting days)
Fats	Every meal	1 thumb

Structure: 3 meals + 1–2 snacks, protein anchored at every one. The 80/20 rule applies — you've already done the restriction diets. We both know how those ended.

Sleep & Stress: Poor sleep alone will stall fat loss with perfect adherence. Fix sleep before cutting a single calorie. Minimums: consistent wake time, 7+ hours in bed, phone out of arm's reach.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

MEAL TIMING

A full day of eating and the why behind every decision

04

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

04 — MEAL TIMING

A Day of Eating.

When you eat matters less than what and how much — but timing it right makes the whole day easier. Here's the rhythm, and the why behind every piece.

FIRST THING Within 1 hr of waking	Water first, then protein. Eggs, Greek yogurt + fruit, or a shake. Coffee is welcome. Coffee is not breakfast.	<i>Protein early steadies hunger for the entire day. Women who skip breakfast aren't 'being good' — they're setting up the 3pm crash and the 9pm pantry tour.</i>
PRE-WORKOUT 60–90 min before	Protein + easy carb. Toast with eggs, yogurt with berries, or half a banana with protein. Light, familiar, nothing heavy.	<i>Fed training means heavier lifts — and heavier lifts keep your muscle while the fat comes off. Training fasted is just a worse workout.</i>
POST-WORKOUT Within 1–2 hrs	Your biggest protein hit + carbs. 1–2 palms protein, a cupped hand of carbs, veggies. Best place for your training-day extra carb serving.	<i>Muscle is the engine of fat loss — feed the engine. Within a couple hours is plenty.</i>
MIDDAY + AFTERNOON	Protein anchor, no 6-hour gaps. Lunch with a palm of protein + a fist of veggies. Planned snack if needed: cottage cheese, jerky, fruit + cheese.	<i>Long empty gaps are where evening overeating is born. A 200-calorie planned snack at 3pm beats an unplanned 600 at 9pm. That's math.</i>
DINNER	Two palms of protein, carbs allowed. Yes, carbs at night. They do not turn into fat after 7pm — that myth needs to retire.	<i>Total daily intake decides fat loss, not the clock. Carbs at dinner also help most women sleep better.</i>
BEFORE BED Stop ~2 hrs out	Kitchen closes. Genuinely hungry? Greek yogurt or cottage cheese — slow-digesting, easy on sleep.	<i>Heavy late meals wreck deep sleep, and poor sleep stalls fat loss even with perfect adherence.</i>

Non-training days: same rhythm, minus the pre/post-workout pieces. Drop the extra carb serving. Evening workouts? Shift the frame, keep the order.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

THE ESTROGEN FOOD LIST

Foods that support clearance and reduce inflammation

05

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

Eat for your hormones.

Your liver processes and clears excess estrogen. When it can't keep up — poor diet, high stress, insufficient fiber — estrogen recirculates, driving bloating, mood swings, weight gain, and fatigue. These foods support that clearance process.

Food	Why It Matters	How to Use It
Cruciferous vegetables (broccoli, Brussels sprouts, kale, cauliflower)	Support liver detox — help your body process and clear excess estrogen	Roasted as a side, raw in salads, sautéed with eggs
Flax & chia seeds	Bind excess estrogen in the gut and support elimination	Add to shakes, yogurt, overnight oats
Berries	High in antioxidants that reduce inflammation and support liver function	With breakfast, in shakes, as snacks
Avocado	Healthy fat that supports hormone production and liver detox	In bowls, on eggs, as a snack
Lemon	Supports liver and bile production — essential for fat digestion and estrogen clearance	In water, dressings, over fish
Sweet potato, carrots, squash	Fiber and beta-carotene support estrogen metabolism and elimination	Roasted with dinner, mashed as a side
Salmon & sardines	Omega-3s reduce inflammation and support hormone detox and production	Grilled, baked, in salads
Olive oil	Anti-inflammatory fat that supports hormone function and liver health	Cooking oil, salad dressings

The daily non-negotiables:

- 30g of protein at breakfast — before coffee if you can manage it
- Electrolytes with water first thing in the morning
- 8,000–10,000 steps throughout the day
- 5+ servings of vegetables
- 7+ hours of sleep — protect this like a training session
- One moment of stress relief: a walk, sunlight, five minutes of quiet

Morning sunlight: 5–10 minutes within 30 minutes of waking sets your circadian rhythm and has a measurable effect on cortisol regulation all day. Free. Takes 5 minutes.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

NEAT — YOUR SECRET WEAPON

The most underused fat loss tool in your day

06

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

Move more. Outside the gym.

NEAT stands for Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis — every calorie you burn through movement that isn't a formal workout. Walking, standing, doing dishes, taking the stairs, pacing on a call. It can burn more total calories over the course of a day than a single hour-long workout. And unlike intense exercise, it doesn't raise cortisol.

The women making the most progress aren't always the ones training hardest. They're the ones moving most consistently throughout the entire day.

How to Increase Your NEAT

- Walk after meals — 10–15 minutes lowers blood sugar and adds to your daily step count without any extra effort
- Take calls standing or walking — voice memos, walking meetings, pacing while you think
- Park farther, take the stairs — not for the calorie burn, but because the habit rewires your default
- Stand while you cook, fold laundry, take calls — any upright time counts
- Set a movement reminder every hour if you have a desk job — even 2 minutes standing resets circulation

NEAT vs. Your Workout

	Formal Workout	NEAT (daily movement)
Duration	45–60 min	All day
Cortisol impact	Moderate to high	Minimal
Calories burned	300–500 (varies widely)	200–600+ (adds up quietly)
Consistency required	3–4x/week	Every day
Barrier to entry	High — scheduling, gear, energy	Low — built into existing habits

NEAT is free. It compounds. And it's the most underused tool in your fat loss toolkit.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

MEAL GUIDE

Protein reality check + your full meal rotation

07

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

07 — PROTEIN REALITY CHECK

What a real protein portion actually looks like.

Most women are eating about half the protein they need — not because they don't want to, but because they don't know what the right amount looks like on a plate. These are single-ingredient protein sources and what they actually deliver.

Protein Source	Serving Size	Protein
Grilled Chicken Breast	4 oz cooked	25g
Cottage Cheese	1 cup	24g
Lean Ground Beef / Turkey (93/7)	4 oz cooked	23g
Wild-Caught Salmon	4 oz cooked	22g
Plain Greek Yogurt	1 cup	20g
Large Whole Eggs	2 eggs	12g
Almonds	1 oz / small handful	7g

Your protein and your fiber. If you track nothing else, track those two. Aim for 30–40g of protein per meal across 3–4 meals a day.

Reading this table:

- Greek yogurt and cottage cheese are underrated — they're not just snacks, they're protein anchors
- Eggs alone won't get you there — 2 eggs is 12g, which is a start not a meal
- Almonds are a fat source first, protein source second — great for snacks, not your protein anchor
- 4 oz of chicken, salmon, or beef at dinner gets you to 22–25g in one ingredient

The goal is 30–40g per meal. Look at this table and ask yourself: am I actually hitting that? Most women aren't.

07 — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Breakfast.

Protein first. Every time. Coffee is not breakfast.

The Power Scramble + Berries

Ingredients: 2–3 eggs, 1 handful fresh spinach, 1 slice sourdough bread, 1/4 avocado, 1 cup mixed berries

Instructions: Scramble eggs over medium heat, toss spinach in last 60 seconds to wilt. Toast sourdough, mash avocado on top with sea salt. Serve with berries on the side.

Spiced Apple Cottage Cheese Bowl

Ingredients: 1 cup cottage cheese, 1/2 apple (diced), 1 tbsp walnuts, 1 tsp honey, cinnamon

Instructions: Scoop cottage cheese into a bowl. Top with diced apple and walnuts. Dust with cinnamon, finish with a light drizzle of honey.

Superfood Greek Yogurt Bowl

Ingredients: 1 cup plain non-fat Greek yogurt, 1/3 cup low-sugar high-protein granola, 1 tbsp ground flaxseed, 1 tbsp chia seeds, 1/2 cup fresh fruit

Instructions: Layer yogurt into a bowl. Top with granola, flaxseed, and chia seeds. Finish with fresh fruit.

Grab-and-Go Cottage Cheese Egg Muffins (Prep-Ahead)

Ingredients: 12 eggs, 1 cup cottage cheese, 1 bell pepper (diced), 2 green onions (sliced), 1 cup spinach (chopped), salt + pepper

Instructions: Preheat oven 350°F. Whisk eggs and cottage cheese until smooth. Stir in veggies. Pour into greased muffin tin. Bake 20–25 min. Grab 2–3 for an instant breakfast all week.

07 — LUNCH OPTIONS

Lunch.

Simple, meal-prepable, and protein-forward. Make extra — it becomes tomorrow's lunch too.

The Ultimate Everyday Deli Sandwich

Ingredients: 4 oz lean deli turkey, 1 slice swiss or provolone, romaine, tomato, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp dijon. Side: 1/2 avocado + fresh fruit

Instructions: Build sandwich with sourdough, turkey, cheese, lettuce, tomato, dijon. Serve with sliced avocado and a side of fresh fruit.

High-Protein Garden Harvest Salad

Ingredients: 4–6 oz grilled chicken or shrimp, 3 cups mixed greens, 1/2 cucumber, 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes, 1/4 cup shredded carrots. Dressing: 1 tbsp olive oil + 1/2 lemon juiced

Instructions: Toss greens, cucumber, tomatoes, carrots. Top with grilled chicken or shrimp. Drizzle with olive oil and fresh lemon. Salt and pepper to taste.

Clean-Kitchen Chicken Salad Boats

Ingredients: 4–6 oz shredded chicken, 2 tbsp plain Greek yogurt, 1/2 lemon juiced, 1 celery stalk (diced), salt + pepper, romaine leaves or 1 slice sourdough

Instructions: Mix chicken, Greek yogurt, lemon juice, celery. Season to taste. Scoop into romaine leaves or serve over toasted sourdough.

Sautéed Shrimp + Zesty Cabbage Slaw Box

Ingredients: 5–6 oz shrimp, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 lime juiced, 2–3 cups shredded cabbage mix, 1 tsp olive oil, 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar, pinch sea salt

Instructions: Toss cabbage with olive oil, vinegar, salt. Sear shrimp with garlic powder 2 min per side. Squeeze lime over shrimp. Serve over slaw.

07 — DINNER OPTIONS

Dinner.

Pantry-friendly. 15–30 minutes. Two palms of protein minimum.

15-Minute Ground Turkey Stir-Fry

Ingredients: 1 lb lean ground turkey, 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder, 4 cups frozen stir-fry veg blend, 2–3 tbsp low-sodium soy sauce or coconut aminos. Optional: jasmine rice

Instructions: Brown turkey in skillet, season with garlic + onion powder. Add frozen veg, pour in soy sauce, sauté 4–5 min. Serve as-is for low carb or over rice.

Street-Style Shrimp Tacos with Avocado Slaw

Ingredients: 1 lb shrimp, 1 tbsp taco seasoning, 4–6 corn tortillas, 2 cups shredded cabbage, 1 lime juiced, 1/2 avocado sliced, fresh cilantro

Instructions: Toss shrimp in taco seasoning, sauté 4–5 min. Toss cabbage with lime juice + cilantro. Warm tortillas, fill with shrimp, top with slaw and avocado.

Pan-Seared Salmon + Green Bean Roast

Ingredients: 2 salmon fillets, 1 lb green beans (trimmed), 2 cups broccoli florets, 1 tbsp olive oil, garlic powder, sea salt, black pepper

Instructions: Preheat oven 400°F. Toss veg with olive oil + seasoning on sheet pan. Season salmon same way, place alongside veg. Roast 12–15 min until salmon flakes and broccoli edges crisp.

Classic Sheet-Pan Chicken + Sweet Potato

Ingredients: 1 lb chicken thighs or breasts (cubed), 2 medium sweet potatoes (cubed), 1 bunch asparagus, 1 tbsp olive oil, smoked paprika, oregano, garlic powder, salt + pepper

Instructions: Preheat oven 400°F. Combine chicken, sweet potato, asparagus on sheet pan. Drizzle with olive oil, season with spices, toss to coat. Bake 25 min until chicken is cooked through.

07 — GRAB + GO BISTRO BOXES

Grab + Go Bistro Boxes.

No cooking required. Grab a 4-compartment container and build these cold. Perfect for busy days, travel, or when you just don't want to cook.

Box	Protein	Fiber + Crunch	Fats + Extras
The Chicken Skewer Box	4–6 oz grilled chicken cubes or skewers	Sugar snap peas, cherry tomatoes, sliced radishes, mixed berries	Cubed cheddar cheese, whole almonds, baby dill pickles
The Classic Deli + Crunch Box	4–6 oz rolled lean deli turkey + 1 hard-boiled egg (halved)	Sliced cucumber, celery sticks, sliced radishes, fresh fruit or berries	Swiss cheese slices + a handful of raw almonds
The Mediterranean Power Box	4–5 turkey or chicken meatballs (or sliced grilled chicken)	Sliced zucchini rounds, fresh cucumber, cherry tomatoes	2 tbsp hummus, kalamata olives, light sprinkle of feta or grilled halloumi
The Quick Seafood + Fats Box	5–6 oz chilled shrimp with fresh lemon wedge (or canned sardines / tuna)	Baby spinach, cucumber slices, fresh berries	1 hard-boiled egg (halved), raw walnut halves, pumpkin seeds

Build these Sunday. They keep 3–4 days in the fridge. Zero excuses for skipping lunch.

A Sample Week.

One way to rotate these meals across 7 days. Repeat what worked, swap what didn't. Consistency beats variety every time.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snack / Box
Mon	Power Scramble + Berries	Garden Harvest Salad	Sheet-Pan Chicken + Sweet Potato	Hard Boiled Eggs
Tue	Cottage Cheese Bowl	Deli Sandwich	Ground Turkey Stir-Fry	Chicken Skewer Box
Wed	Greek Yogurt Bowl	Chicken Salad Boats	Shrimp Tacos	Classic Deli + Crunch Box
Thu	Egg Muffins (prep ahead)	Shrimp + Cabbage Slaw Box	Salmon + Green Bean Roast	Mediterranean Power Box
Fri	Power Scramble + Berries	Garden Harvest Salad	Ground Turkey Stir-Fry	Hard Boiled Eggs
Sat	Cottage Cheese Bowl	Chicken Salad Boats	Sheet-Pan Chicken + Sweet Potato	Quick Seafood + Fats Box
Sun	Greek Yogurt Bowl	Deli Sandwich	Shrimp Tacos	Cottage Cheese + EBS

Prep tip: Cook a batch of chicken thighs or ground turkey on Sunday. It covers 3–4 meals with zero extra effort mid-week. Build 2–3 bistro boxes at the same time.

07 — GROCERY LIST

Your Grocery List.

Everything for the full rotation. Simple, affordable, repeatable.

Proteins	Produce	Dairy + Eggs	Pantry + Staples
Chicken thighs Chicken breast Lean ground turkey Shrimp Salmon fillets Lean deli turkey Canned tuna / sardines Lean ground beef (93/7)	Fresh spinach Romaine lettuce Green beans Broccoli florets Asparagus Cabbage / coleslaw mix Bell pepper Cucumber Cherry tomatoes Radishes Celery Green onions Avocado Apple Fresh berries Lemon + lime	Eggs (1 dozen) Cottage cheese Plain Greek yogurt Swiss or provolone Cheddar cheese Feta (optional) Halloumi (optional)	Sourdough bread Corn tortillas Jasmine rice Sweet potatoes Low-sugar granola Ground flaxseed Chia seeds Almonds + walnuts Pumpkin seeds Olive oil Dijon mustard Coconut aminos / soy sauce Taco seasoning Smoked paprika Garlic powder Sea salt + pepper Apple cider vinegar Honey (small bottle) Hummus Kalamata olives

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

THE IDEAL WEEK

What the full week looks like laid out

08

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

The Full Week.

This is the shape, not the law. Move days around to fit your actual life — the only rule is everything gets done by Sunday.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
STRENGTH Lower Squat focus 45–55 min + finisher	LISS CARDIO Zone 2 35–45 min Conversation pace	STRENGTH Upper Push focus 45–55 min + finisher	INTERVALS 30s hard / 90s easy × 8–10 20 min total	STRENGTH Full Body Hinge focus 45–55 min + carries	ACTIVE RECOVERY Long walk, hike, yardwork — move	REST + RESET Groceries, prep 2–3 proteins, plan the week
8–10k steps	8–10k steps	8–10k steps	8–10k steps	8–10k steps	8–10k steps	8–10k steps

Daily Anchors

Protein at every meal (palm rule) · Steps before scrolling · 7+ hours in bed, consistent wake time · Weigh-ins Mon · Wed · Fri, averaged

Missed a day? Slide it, don't skip it. Two strength days in a row beats zero.

THE STANDARD FAT LOSS SYSTEM

CHECK-INS & ADJUSTMENTS

How to measure progress and what to do when it stalls

09

"We're not meant to have the same body forever."

09 — CHECK-INS

Progress is measured weekly. Judged monthly.

One bad weigh-in is water, sleep, stress, or your cycle — not failure. We look at trends, not single data points.

Weekly Metrics

Metric	How Often	What We're Looking For
Scale weight	3x/week, averaged	Trend of 0.5–1% bodyweight/week down
Waist measurement	1x/week, same conditions	Slow downward trend
Photos	Every 2 weeks	Front / side / back, same lighting
Energy & sleep rating	Weekly, 1–10	Holding steady or improving

Losing faster than 1% per week? We add food back. Fast loss is muscle loss, and muscle is the whole point.

When Fat Loss Stalls — The Adjustment Ladder

Stalled means 3+ weeks with no trend change and honest adherence. Pull ONE lever at a time, in this order:

Step	Lever	The Move
1	Steps	Add 1–2k to the daily target
2	Calories	Drop 100–150/day
3	Cardio	Add ONE session — only after steps 1 and 2

Never all three at once. Slashing food and doubling cardio in the same week is a panic move — and panic moves are why the last plan didn't stick.

Have questions? Find me on Instagram @christin_fisher — that's what I'm here for. — Christin This program is general fitness guidance, not medical advice. Check with your doctor before starting, especially if you have existing health conditions.